

C • Church in Conversation

Brand Guidelines — Consolidated V1.0 · 2026-07-23

One-place reference combining the current Writer's Quick Reference (voice/messaging, updated 2026-07-22) and the Logo Usage Sheet (visual identity, approved 2026-07-18). Built for handoff/upload use — team onboarding, Canva Brand Kit setup, etc.

The Name

Church in Conversation — no "The." Masterbrand on everything public.

- Internal short form: **CiC**
- Experiential short form: **"the Table"**
- Era series titles sit beneath the masterbrand, never alone — e.g. *Conversations with the Early Church*.

Say It in One Breath

"Church in Conversation rebuilds documented Christian movements from their own words — and you don't just read about them: you join them at a table where they talk with you, and with each other — openly."

Three Words

Transparent · Inviting · Experiential

The Voice — Five Pairs

Every sentence survives all five.

- **Witness but not recruiting** — state the mission plainly; never push.
- **Rigorous but not distracting** — scholarship underneath, one click away.
- **Accessible but not shallow** — everyday English; full depth reachable.
- **Technology but not seen** — experience first, governance second, mechanism third.
- **Relational but not human** — real conversation; never pretends to be a person.

Sound like: N.T. Wright · Tim Mackie · Justo González — a scholar-host at a table. Warmth through shared discovery, not comfort. BibleProject balance; 10th-grade reading floor.

The Four Messages, in Order

1. **The whole Church, in the open** — many movements, one table, real disagreement.
2. **It shows its work** — sources and confidence visible; "where the historical record is thin, we let the silence stand."
3. **Witness, never recruitment** — representing each movement in full, testimony beautiful and hard alike; what it means for you is yours to own and share.
4. **The build is the product** — months of review-gated scholarship; free to any seeker; "help us build the next world."

Use Verbatim — Never Paraphrase

- *"A doorway to sit with the Christian movements of history"*
- *"We measure whether each Christian movement is represented in an engaging and accurate way. What it means for you is yours to own and share."*
- *"We are committed to representing each Christian movement in full — its testimony, beautiful and hard alike."*
- *"Come and join us at the Table"*
- *"Twenty centuries of the Church. One table. A chair pulled out for you."*
- *"Where the historical record is thin, we let the silence stand."*

Never

"Finding the right answers" (or any promised answers) · promised transformation (testify with real quotes only, never promise) · urgency or scarcity · "the only / the first" · hype and exclamation marks · engagement numbers as success · the founder in the spotlight · a single tradition as the face of the project · Christianese or project jargon · "users" · "honest/honestly" as the catch-all word (say *open*, *transparent*, or the concrete thing) · "authentic/authentically" · denying a suspicion nobody raised — say what it is, once, and stop · "talking" as the primary word for the interaction (say *conversation*) · stacked "not X, it's Y" contrast as a sentence shape, even when true — it reads as generated, not crafted.

Always

Raise the AI trust question yourself, first — then answer it (locked to sources, shows confidence, tested, reviewed — and what's unfinished, said plainly). Show the work before the caveat. Real dates, no deadlines. Participation verbs: join, ask, meet, explore. Numbers: check with Mark before print. Say "conversation," not "talking." A clarifying contrast naming what kind of thing this is stays fine — the rule targets *denial*, not *category*.

Who We're Writing To

Publicly: anyone curious how differently Christians have known Jesus — the curious, the searching, the rebuilding. Silently prioritized: the person whose faith is unraveling, and the person who's never seen past one doorway. **The seeker's voice always outranks the donor's.**

Visual Identity — The Mark

The C-as-table: a single ring stroke, opening facing right, with one madder dot outside the mouth, at the threshold. Ink on parchment. Never any third element.

The public sentence (said once beside the mark at first contact, never elaborated in donor material): *"The mark is a table; the opening is the way in — and it never closes."*



Files

File	Use
CiC_Logo_Arriving_Master.svg	Identity master, light grounds. Use at 48px and larger.
CiC_Logo_Arriving_Master_Dark.svg	Same geometry on dark tokens (#EDE5D6 / #CB6E52).
CiC_Logo_Arriving_Geometric.svg	Even-stroke variant — animation form and the below-48px form.
CiC_Logo_Arriving_Favicon.svg	Favicon/app-icon master, optically compensated. Source for .ico 16/24/32/48, apple-touch 180, PWA 512.
CiC_Logo_Arriving_Motion_Reference.html	The motion implementation, drop-in CSS/SVG.

Colors

Ink #2A2521 — primary line/text color

Madder #A13E2B — threshold dot only

Dark-reg. #EDE5D6

Dark-reg. #CB6E52

Madder is never brightened, never duplicated, never recolored.

Geometry

ViewBox 100 · ring center (50,50) r 31 · opening $\pm 50^\circ$ · dot r 6.5 at (88.5, 50), always outside the ring, never inside in any state.

Clearspace & Minimum Sizes

- Clearspace: the ring's stroke width (11/100 of the mark) on all sides — nothing enters it, including the wordmark outside lockup spacing.
- Minimums: mark alone 16px (geometric variant below 48px); modulated master never below 48px; full lockup minimum 120px wide.

Wordmark & Lockup

Church *in* Conversation, set in **Alegreya** — roman, italic "in," no "The." Mark at cap-height $\times 1.6$; clearspace between mark and wordmark = one dot diameter. No body/UI typeface is locked in yet — don't declare one as final in any brand kit tool until that's decided.

The Never-List (the Mark)

Never a cross, dove, flame, or speech bubble; nothing tech-flavored · the dot never inside the ring, never duplicated, never another color · the opening never narrowed, closed, or pointed anywhere but right · madder never brightened · never on photography without a parchment or ink plate · never spun, bounced, pulsed at alert speed, or moved to attract a click.

Companion Illustration

The table-and-chair glyph (`CiC_Mark_TableChair_*.svg`) is **illustration, not identity** — empty states, tour art, print corners. Never presented as the logo, never in the favicon slot, never adjacent to the mark in the same composition (two table-metaphors side by side read as two brands).

Status: Visual identity: art approved (Mark, 2026-07-18) — no open items on the mark itself. Voice/messaging: current as of 2026-07-22 (six protected lines revised that round). Still open: rasterized .ico/.png export, vector wordmark outlines (needs the Alegreya font asset), trademark screening of the mark.

Source documents: `Ministry/Communication/CiC_Messaging_Branding_Kit_QuickRef_V0_1.md` · `Ministry/Communication/Brand-Assets/CiC_Logo_Usage_Sheet_V1_0.md`